

which already runs Android 4.0. Motorola offers features like the data cap setting on its Razer.

Unique to Motorola is SmartActions. This app automates a variety of functions to extend battery life and allows the override of silent settings for specific callers.

Open source robotic vehicle making waves, literally!

For all those who wish to explore the depth of an ocean, here is some interesting news. The OpenROV kit, a do-it-yourself kit that assembles into an underwater robot, is creating a lot of buzz.

The brainchild of Eric Stackpole, the kit involves soldering, gluing and wiring of electronics. Stackpole began by developing this ROV (remotely operated vehicle) along with a community of engineers and scientists from over 50 countries. As the community grew, the OpenROV project found immense applications, be it monitoring of pollution in streams or species identification in Antarctica. The OpenROV is 30cm long, 20cm wide and 15cm tall. Designed to go as deep as 100m, it weighs just 2.5 kg. It is powered by three 800 kv brushless motors. While two horizontal thrusters allow the ROV to move forward and aft as well as rotate, a vertical thruster allows the (neutrally buoyant) vehicle to change depth.



Mozilla to launch Firefox OS in 2013

Google and Apple will have to face some competition in the smartphone arena, as the Mozilla Foundation is planning to launch its Firefox operating system devices in early 2013. Mozilla previously named the mobile platform as the Open Web Devices platform (OWD), and now it is called the Firefox OS.

Alcatel One Touch and ZTE have been selected to make Firefox OS devices using Snapdragon chips from Qualcomm. It is expected that the first lot of devices will be launched in Brazil in early 2013 through the Spain-based telecom giant Telefónica.

The technical specifications of the smartphone are still not available.



Chrome 20 gives security net to Linux users

Chrome version 20 is welcome news for Linux users, especially because it introduces a new sandbox concept, which regulates and filters the system. Security features and other add-ons in the Chrome browser did not recognise Linux till now. Features like restricting hazardous plug-ins like Flash to a secure sandbox were mainly restricted for the Windows versions.

In February, this year, Google introduced Pepper Flash for 64-bit Linux,



which primarily isolates the plug-in process and blocks communication with other processes. Fortunately, the recently announced Chrome 20 adds a secure computing sandbox for Linux users.

Seccomp is a security extension for the Linux kernel, which restricts the system calls a thread can make. It was originally designed to limit calls to just reading and writing via previously opened file handles (`read()`, `write()`) and proper termination (`exit()`, `sigreturn()`). If a restricted thread attempts to make any other system call, the kernel terminates it directly. To make it more widely usable, the developers added the ability to have system calls sent to a special broker, which checks calls against a list of permitted functions and checks any arguments before forwarding them to the system.

According to Google developer, Chris Evans, Chrome 20's native 64-bit Flash plug-in is, at least in the current Ubuntu 12.04, isolated within a seccomp sandbox, thus complementing the Pepper Flash sandbox.